

HEAD

1. Passage anchor

> “At that time, I was quite shy and tended to **keep my head down in class**.”

Passage meaning

****keep your head down**** = avoid attracting attention; stay quiet and unobtrusive

****保持低調；避免引人注意；默默做事****

In the passage, this is figurative rather than merely physical. The speaker was shy, afraid of saying the wrong thing, and therefore tried not to draw attention.

Practice

1. During my first few weeks at the new job, I just ****kept my head down**** and learned how everything worked.

我剛開始新工作那幾週只是****保持低調****，先弄清楚所有事情怎麼運作。

2. He prefers to ****keep his head down**** and avoid office drama.

他比較喜歡****低調行事****，避免捲入辦公室是非。

Core meanings of HEAD

2. head — the upper part of the body

= the part of the body containing the brain, eyes, ears, nose, and mouth

****頭；頭部****

Examples

1. He hit his ****head**** on the door.

他的****頭****撞到了門。

2. She nodded her ****head**** slowly.

她慢慢地****點了點頭****。

Common combinations:

* shake your head 搖頭

* nod your head 點頭

* turn your head 轉頭

* raise your head 抬頭

* lower your head 低頭

3. head — mind / brain / thinking

= the mind, especially as the place of thought, memory, or judgment

頭腦；腦子；思緒

Examples

1. I can't get that song out of my **head**.

我一直無法把那首歌從**腦海中**忘掉。

2. Use your **head** before making a decision.

做決定前先**動動腦筋**。

This is a major figurative extension from the physical head.

4. have something in your head

= have an idea, thought, plan, or image in your mind

腦中有；心裡想著

Examples

1. I already have a rough idea **in my head**.

我**腦中**已經有一個大概的想法。

2. She had the whole speech **in her head**.

她整篇演講都記在**腦子裡**。

5. get something into your head

= come to believe or decide something, sometimes stubbornly or irrationally

認定；一心認為；突然有某種念頭

Examples

1. He **got it into his head** that everyone disliked him.

他**一口咬定 / 認定**大家都不喜歡他。

2. She **got the idea into her head** that she should quit immediately.
她突然**認定**自己應該立刻辭職。

Often slightly critical.

Position and direction

6. head — top, front, or leading end of something

= the top, front, or most important end of an object, line, or group

頂端；前端；首位

Examples

1. She stood at the **head of the line**.
她站在隊伍的**最前面**。
2. His name appears at the **head of the list**.
他的名字出現在名單的**最上方**。

7. head of the table

= the most important or leading position at a table

桌子的主位；上座

Examples

1. The host sat at the **head of the table**.
主人坐在桌子的**主位**。
2. She was invited to sit at the **head of the table**.
她受邀坐在**上座**。

This can also imply status or leadership.

8. head — leader or person in charge

= the person who leads or controls an organization, department, school, etc.

負責人；主管；首長

Examples

1. She is the **head of the department**.
她是部門**主管**。
2. He became **head of marketing** last year.
他去年成為行銷部門的**負責人**。

Common:

- * head teacher 校長 / 主任教師, depending on system
- * department head 部門主管
- * head of state 國家元首
- * head of government 政府首腦

9. head — chief or principal part

= the main, leading, or most important part
主要部分；首要部分

Examples

1. The issue is now at the **head of the agenda**.
這個議題現在位於議程的**首要位置**。
2. Safety should remain at the **head of our priorities**.
安全應該繼續是我們的**首要考量**。

This use is formal and less common than **top** or **forefront** in everyday speech.

Verb: move or direct

10. head somewhere

= go or move in a particular direction
前往；朝……走去

Examples

1. We're **heading home** now.
我們現在正**回家**。

2. She **headed toward the station**.

她**朝車站走去**。

Very common in spoken English.

11. head for somewhere

= move toward a destination

前往；朝.....前進

Examples

1. Let's **head for the beach** before it gets crowded.

我們趁還沒人多之前**去海灘吧**。

2. The ship **headed for the harbour**.

那艘船**駛向港口**。

12. be headed for something

= be moving toward a place, state, or likely outcome

正朝.....前進；很可能走向.....

Examples

1. We're **headed for trouble** if we ignore the warning signs.

如果我們忽視警訊，就很可能**走向麻煩**。

2. The project seems to be **headed for success**.

這個計畫看起來正**走向成功**。

Often figurative.

13. head a group / organization / project

= lead or be in charge of something

領導；負責

Examples

1. She **heads** the research team.

她**領導**研究團隊。

2. He was chosen to **head** the project.

他被選中**負責**這個專案。

This comes directly from the noun sense “leader.”

14. head a list

= appear first on a list or ranking

名列榜首；位居首位

Examples

1. The novel **headed** the bestseller list for six weeks.

這本小說連續六週**高居暢銷榜榜首**。

2. She **heads** the list of candidates.

她位居候選人名單的**首位**。

Intelligence, control, and composure

15. keep your head

= stay calm and think clearly in a difficult situation

保持冷靜；保持清醒

Examples

1. Everyone panicked, but she **kept her head**.

大家都慌了，但她仍然**保持冷靜**。

2. Try to **keep your head** in an emergency.

緊急情況下要盡量**保持冷靜**。

16. lose your head

= panic or become so excited or emotional that you stop thinking clearly

慌了手腳；失去理智

Examples

1. Don't **lose your head** just because something went wrong.
不要因為出了問題就**慌了手腳**。

2. He completely **lost his head** during the argument.
他在爭吵中完全**失去理智**。

Opposite of **keep your head**.

17. have a good head for something

= be naturally good at understanding or dealing with something
對.....很有頭腦；很擅長.....

Examples

1. She has **a good head for numbers**.
她對數字很**有概念 / 很擅長處理數字**。

2. He has **a good head for business**.
他很有**商業頭腦**。

Common:

- * a head for figures
- * a head for business
- * a head for languages

18. head over heart / use your head

use your head = think sensibly and rationally
用腦思考；理性一點

Examples

1. **Use your head**—that offer sounds too good to be true.
動動腦筋，那個提議好得不太真實。

2. This time, I'm going to follow my **head**, not my heart.
這次我要聽從**理性**，而不是感情。

Here **head** represents reason; **heart** often represents emotion.

Attention and posture

19. keep your head down — literal

= keep your head physically lowered

低著頭

Examples

1. **Keep your head down** while walking under the low ceiling.

經過低矮天花板時要**低著頭**。

2. He **kept his head down** to avoid the strong wind.

他**低著頭**避開強風。

This literal sense is the source of the figurative expression in the passage.

20. keep your head down — figurative

= avoid attention, conflict, or trouble

保持低調；不要惹人注意；避開麻煩

Examples

1. I decided to **keep my head down** until the situation calmed down.

我決定先**保持低調**，等情況平靜下來。

2. He just wants to do his job and **keep his head down**.

他只想把工作做好並**低調行事**。

Passage sense

This is the exact use in the passage.

21. hold your head high

= show confidence or dignity, especially after difficulty

****抬頭挺胸；保持自信與尊嚴****

Examples

1. You did your best, so ****hold your head high****.

你已經盡力了，所以要****抬頭挺胸****。

2. She walked out with her ****head held high****.

她****昂首挺胸****地走了出去。

Literal posture → figurative confidence.

22. hang your head

= lower your head because of shame, sadness, or embarrassment

****低下頭；垂頭****

Examples

1. He ****hung his head in shame****.

他羞愧地****低下了頭****。

2. She ****hung her head**** when her mistake was mentioned.

當她的錯誤被提起時，她****垂下了頭****。

Pressure, responsibility, and danger

23. over someone's head

A. physically above someone

****在某人頭頂上方****

B. too difficult for someone to understand

****超出某人的理解能力****

Examples

1. The joke went completely ****over my head****.

那個笑話我完全****沒聽懂****。

2. Most of the technical discussion was **over his head**.

大部分技術討論都**超出了他的理解範圍**。

Very common figurative sense.

24. go over someone's head

= bypass someone in authority and speak to a more senior person

越級處理；越過某人直接找上級

Examples

1. She **went over her manager's head** and contacted the director.

她**越過經理直接聯絡主管**。

2. He was annoyed that they had **gone over his head**.

他對他們**越級行事**感到不滿。

Distinct from “too difficult to understand.”

25. hanging over someone's head

= threatening, worrying, or likely to cause trouble in the future

懸在頭上的威脅；一直造成壓力

Examples

1. The deadline has been **hanging over my head** all week.

那個截止日期整週都像壓力一樣**懸在我心頭**。

2. The possibility of losing his job **hung over his head**.

失業的可能性一直像威脅般**籠罩著他**。

Quantity and counting

26. per head

= for each person

每人；按人頭計

Examples

1. The meal costs fifty dollars ****per head****.
這頓飯****每人****五十美元。

2. The budget is calculated ****per head****.
預算是按****人頭****計算的。

27. head — one animal, especially livestock

= one individual animal when counting cattle or other livestock
****頭 (牲畜量詞)****

Examples

1. The farm has two hundred ****head of cattle****.
這座農場有兩百****頭牛****。

2. They sold fifty ****head of sheep****.
他們賣了五十****頭羊****。

This is an established agricultural counting use.

Objects and structural parts

28. head — top or end part of an object

= the upper, front, rounded, or working end of something
****頭部；頂端；端部****

Examples

1. The ****head of the hammer**** is made of steel.
鎚子的****鎚頭****是鋼製的。

2. The screw has a flat ****head****.
這顆螺絲有一個平的****螺絲頭****。

Common:

* hammer head 鎚頭

* screw head 螺絲頭

- * nail head 釘頭
- * shower head 蓮蓬頭

29. head of a bed

= the end of a bed where a person's head normally rests

****床頭****

Examples

1. There is a lamp at the ****head of the bed****.
****床頭****有一盞燈。
2. She placed the pillow at the ****head of the bed****.
她把枕頭放在****床頭****。

30. head — top layer of foam

= foam on top of a drink, especially beer

****泡沫層；啤酒泡沫****

Examples

1. The beer had a thick ****head****.
那杯啤酒上有一層厚厚的****泡沫****。
2. Pour it slowly so you don't create too much ****head****.
慢慢倒，以免產生太多****泡沫****。

Lower-priority but established.

Plants and food

31. head of lettuce / cabbage

= a compact rounded mass of leaves forming one whole vegetable

****一顆萵苣 / 高麗菜****

Examples

1. We need one **head of lettuce**.

我們需要一**顆萵苣**。

2. She chopped a **head of cabbage**.

她切了一**顆高麗菜**。

This is a lexicalized count unit.

32. flower head

= the flowering top of a plant, often made of many small flowers

花頭；花序

Examples

1. The plant produces large yellow **flower heads**.

這種植物會長出大型黃色**花序**。

2. Remove the dead **flower heads** regularly.

定期摘除枯萎的**花頭**。

Natural features and geography

33. head of a river / valley / bay

= the upper, furthest, or starting end of a geographical feature

源頭；最裡端；頂端

Examples

1. They camped near the **head of the valley**.

他們在山谷的**最裡端**附近露營。

2. The village lies at the **head of the bay**.

那個村莊位於海灣的**最深處**。

Translation depends on geography.

34. headwaters

= streams or waters near the source of a river

****河源；上游源頭****

Examples

1. The river's ****headwaters**** lie in the mountains.

這條河的****源頭水域****位於山區。

2. Pollution has affected the ****headwaters****.

污染已影響到****河源地區****。

Useful compound, especially in geography/environment.

Competition and comparison

35. head-to-head

= directly competing against one another

****正面交鋒；直接對決****

Examples

1. The two teams will go ****head-to-head**** tomorrow.

兩支隊伍明天將****正面交鋒****。

2. The candidates faced each other in a ****head-to-head debate****.

候選人在一場****一對一直接交鋒的辯論****中碰面。

Can be adjective or adverbial.

36. ahead / head connection

****ahead**** historically contains the idea of being “at/on the head/front,” but in modern English it functions as a separate lexical item.

It is better curated separately:

* ahead = 在前面；領先；提前

Fixed expressions and idioms

37. from head to toe

= over the whole body

從頭到腳；全身

Examples

1. She was dressed in black **from head to toe**.

她**從頭到腳**都穿黑色。

2. I was soaked **from head to toe**.

我**全身上下**都濕透了。

38. head first / headfirst

A. with the head leading

頭朝前地

B. without enough thought; impulsively

一頭栽進；不加思索地投入

Examples

1. He fell **headfirst** into the water.

他**頭朝下 / 頭先入水**掉進水裡。

2. She jumped **headfirst into** the new project.

她**一頭投入**這個新專案。

39. head over heels

A. physically tumbling

翻滾；頭腳顛倒

B. completely in love

神魂顛倒地愛上；深深愛上

Examples

1. He fell ****head over heels in love**** with her.
他****深深愛上了她****。

2. She was ****head over heels**** for him.
她對他****愛得神魂顛倒****。

The romantic use is by far the more common modern idiom.

40. put your heads together

= think or work together to solve something
****一起動腦；集思廣益****

Examples

1. Let's ****put our heads together**** and find a solution.
我們來****一起動腦****找解決辦法。

2. The team ****put their heads together**** to redesign the system.
團隊****集思廣益****重新設計系統。

41. get your head around something

= succeed in understanding something difficult
****理解；搞懂****

Examples

1. I'm still trying to ****get my head around**** the new system.
我還在努力****搞懂****新系統。

2. It took me a while to ****get my head around**** the idea.
我花了一點時間才****理解這個概念****。

Especially common in British English, but widely understood.

42. bury your head in the sand

= deliberately ignore a problem or unpleasant reality

****逃避現實；對問題視而不見****

Examples

1. We can't just ****bury our heads in the sand****.

我們不能只是****逃避現實****。

2. He ****buried his head in the sand**** instead of dealing with the problem.

他沒有處理問題，反而選擇****逃避****。

43. bite someone's head off

= reply to someone very angrily

****劈頭痛罵；兇巴巴地回話****

Examples

1. I only asked a question—there's no need to ****bite my head off****.

我只是問個問題，你不用這麼****兇地罵我****。

2. She nearly ****bit his head off**** for being late.

他遲到時，她差點****把他罵得狗血淋頭****。

Informal and figurative.

44. heads up

= a warning or advance notice

****提醒；預先通知****

Examples

1. Thanks for the ****heads-up**** about the schedule change.

謝謝你****事先提醒****行程變更。

2. Just a ****heads-up****—the road is closed ahead.

****先提醒你一下****，前面的路封了。

Usually written ****heads-up**** as a noun.

45. give someone a heads-up

= warn or inform someone in advance

****事先提醒某人****

Examples

1. Please ****give me a heads-up**** if the meeting time changes.
如果會議時間有變，請****提前告訴我****。

2. She ****gave us a heads-up**** about the delay.
她****事先提醒我們****會延誤。

46. make heads or tails of something

= understand something at all

****搞懂；弄明白****

Usually negative:

****can't make heads or tails of...****

Examples

1. I can't ****make heads or tails of**** these instructions.
我完全****看不懂****這些指示。

2. He couldn't ****make heads or tails of**** the report.
他完全****搞不懂****那份報告。

47. heads will roll

= people will be severely punished or lose their jobs

****有人會受重罰 / 被炒魷魚****

Examples

1. If this mistake becomes public, ****heads will roll****.
如果這個錯誤曝光，****一定會有人受到重罰****。

2. After the scandal, several people expected ****heads to roll****.

醜聞發生後，很多人預料**會有人被撤職**。

Strong, informal figurative expression.

Word-family sweep

48. headed

A. moving in a direction

正前往.....

We're **headed home**.

我們正**回家**。

B. led by someone

由.....領導的

The committee is **headed by Dr. Lee**.

該委員會**由李博士領導**。

49. heading

A. direction

方向

What **heading** are we travelling on?

我們目前朝什麼**方向**前進？

B. title at the top of a section

標題；標頭

Read the **heading** before the paragraph.

閱讀段落前先看**標題**。

This is a genuinely useful derivative with its own common noun senses.

50. headline

= title of a newspaper article or major news item

****新聞標題；頭條****

Examples

1. The story made international ****headlines****.
這則新聞登上了國際****頭條****。

2. I only read the ****headline****.
我只看了****標題****。

A lexicalized compound, highly useful.

51. headless

= without a head; figuratively sometimes lacking leadership

****無頭的；沒有領導的****

Examples

1. The statue is ****headless****.
那座雕像是****沒有頭的****。

2. The organization was effectively ****headless**** after both leaders resigned.
兩位領導者辭職後，這個組織實際上處於****群龍無首****的狀態。

The figurative use is less common.

52. headstrong

= determined to do what you want despite advice from others

****固執的；任性的；倔強的****

Examples

1. He was a ****headstrong teenager****.
他是個很****倔強的青少年****。

2. She can be rather ****headstrong**** when she has made up her mind.
她一旦下定決心，就會變得相當****固執****。

Lexicalized compound; useful but semantically less transparent.

Meaning map

The major semantic branches of **head** are:

physical head

→ **頭部**

head as top/front

→ head of the line

→ **最前面 / 頂端**

head as leader

→ head of department

→ **主管**

head as mind

→ use your head / in my head

→ **頭腦 / 思緒**

head as direction

→ head home / head toward

→ **前往**

head posture

→ keep your head down / hold your head high

→ **低調 / 保持尊嚴**

head as object end

→ hammer head / screw head

→ **頭部 / 端部**

head as whole/count unit

→ head of cattle / head of lettuce

→ **頭 / 顆**

So the word extends from a very concrete body-part meaning into leadership, location, thought, direction, posture, and counting.

Essential contrasts

head vs mind

****head****

often refers informally and figuratively to thinking:

- * use your head
- * get it into your head

****mind****

is the broader concept of thought, awareness, memory, and feeling:

- * change your mind
- * keep something in mind

So ****head**** is often more concrete, informal, and idiomatic.

head vs leader

****head****

= person officially in charge of a group or department

****leader****

= person who leads, whether formally or informally

A person can be a ****leader**** without being the official ****head****.

head to vs go to

Both can mean movement.

****go to****

= neutral movement to a destination

****head to / head for****

= emphasizes setting off or moving in a direction

> We're ****going to**** the station.

> 我們要去車站。

> We're ****heading to**** the station.

> 我們正朝車站前進。

keep your head down vs keep your head

These are very different:

****keep your head down****

= stay unnoticed / avoid attention

****保持低調****

****keep your head****

= stay calm

****保持冷靜****

Passage recap

> “I was quite shy and tended to ****keep my head down in class****.”

Here, ****head**** is part of the fixed expression:

****keep your head down****

The literal image is:

****低著頭，不與人對視****

The figurative meaning is:

****保持低調，不引人注意，不主動出頭****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings in context:

* ****我在課堂上總是很低調****

* ****我往往低著頭，不敢引人注意****

* ****我通常不太敢出頭****

* ****我總是盡量不讓自己成為焦點****

MCQ-ready meaning

****keep your head down****

= ****avoid attracting attention and stay quiet/unobtrusive****

****保持低調；避免引人注意****

It does not merely mean the physical action ****低著頭**** in this passage.